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USER GUIDE FOR FRAMEWORK
IMPLEMENTATION
A-CARE FRAMEWORK FOR OPTIMISING
COMMUNICATION IN AGILE REQUIREMENTS
ELICITATION

AYESHA ZAVERI
UNIVERSITY OF KUALA LUMPUR
KUALA LUMPUR, MALAYSIA

USER GUIDE FOR FRAMEWORK IMPLEMENTATION

Purpose

The A-CARE Framework comprises three phases and employs agile requirements elicitation by means of organized and continuous communication during the identification, validation, and refinement of requirements. This framework combines both principles of communication and of agile, strengthening stakeholder partnership, decreasing the ambiguity of the requirements, and continuous provision of support for adaptive changes throughout the requirements lifecycle.

A (Agile): This framework is designed for agile environments and is focused on iterative development, continuous feedback, and adaptive change throughout the lifecycle of the requirements and the framework.

C (Communication): Communication is the focus of the framework which serves as a primary means for the elicitation, validation, and refinement of the requirements as opposed to the more traditional means of documents.

A (Aligned): This framework employs the more modern, artificial intelligence approaches to evolving requirements throughout all phases of the framework to sustain alignment of the users, development teams, and agile principles with the articulated vision or primary objectives.

R (Requirements): This framework provides a means of systematic treatment of all the requirements, functional and non-functional.

E (Elicitation): Emphasis is placed on the framework as a means of structured discovery, clarification, and prioritization of the requirements.

The four companies currently involved—DANAT, GovQ, OYAH, and Iterative Lab—are currently developing the A-CARE Framework and are engaged in the collection and analysis of primary data. These companies are utilizing cutting-edge methods based on artificial intelligence to enhance communication and requirements elicitation in an agile environment. They have been tackling the intricacies of stakeholder engagement and adaptive changes in requirements management.

I propose the A-CARE Framework with the objective of addressing these problems by concentrating on the systematic elicitation of both the functional and non-functional requirements. The Framework combines conventional agile ceremonies with contemporary artificial intelligence and stakeholder collaboration to methodically and in an organized manner, validating and refining requirements, on a continuous basis. It emphasizes structured discovery, clarification, and prioritization of requirements, and it improves communication across the entire lifecycle of the requirements. This is to ensure that the requirements are aligned to the vision and objectives of the project and to support continuous changes to the project.

Structuring the process of gathering, validating, and refining requirements is the core reason for subdividing elicitation into three distinct phases: Pre-Elicitation, Elicitation, and Post-Elicitation. The distinct activities performed in these phases provide varying levels of improvement to the understanding and definition of the requirements. During Pre-Elicitation, the focus is on understanding the project and the stakeholders to define the scope and gather detailed requirements. The core of the process is the Elicitation phase, where using AI and traditional methods, the requirements are defined and clarified. Then, in post-elicitation, the focus is on iterative alignment and refinement so that the requirements can accommodate the evolving goals of the project and the needs of the stakeholders. This division also serves the purpose of improving the consistency of the process, the overall level of ambiguity, and the communications throughout the phases of the requirements lifecycle.

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Who Should Use This Guide

- Project Managers and Scrum Masters
- Business Analysts and Requirements Engineers
- Product Owners and Product Managers
- Team Leads and Development Managers
- Stakeholder Representatives
- Quality Assurance Professionals

Key Benefits

- 30-40% reduction in requirement misunderstandings (based on pilot studies)
- Improved stakeholder satisfaction and project alignment
- Enhanced adaptability to changing requirements
- Systematic integration of AI and modern tools

Key Principles

- **Stakeholder-Centric:** Places stakeholders at the center of all decisions and processes
- **Communication-Driven:** Prioritizes open dialogue and active listening
- **Agile Aligned:** Integrates with agile practices and sprint management
- **Continuous Validation:** Includes ongoing refinement and quality checks
- **Technology-Enhanced:** Leverages of AI tools where beneficial while maintaining human oversight
- **Traceable:** Maintains complete traceability throughout the requirements lifecycle

Framework Philosophy

This framework integrates:

- **Agile Practices:** Sprint management, iterative development, and continuous feedback
- **Traditional Methods:** Structured documentation, formal processes, and governance
- **AI-Augmented Approaches:** Modern tools for automation, analysis, and enhanced collaboration
- **Stakeholder-Centric Approach:** Relationship building and continuous engagement

Expected Outcomes

By following this framework, your organization will achieve:

- Enhanced stakeholder engagement and satisfaction
- Improved requirement clarity and completeness
- Better traceability and change management
- Reduced scope creep and project delays
- Higher quality deliverables aligned with business objectives
- Efficient adaptation to changing requirements

1. Framework Overview

This Conceptual Framework is a comprehensive, three-phase approach to requirements management that combines traditional and modern techniques with AI-augmented methods. It emphasizes continuous communication, stakeholder collaboration, and quality validation throughout the entire requirements lifecycle. This framework is designed to bridge the gap between traditional requirements gathering and modern Agile delivery. It is specifically optimized for high-stakes environments where AI integration, legacy data debt, and regulatory compliance (like KYC) are critical factors.

Phase	Focus Area	Key Outcome
Pre-Elicitation	Preparation and Foundation Building	Stakeholder readiness and communication infrastructure
Elicitation	Active Requirements Gathering	Documented and prioritized requirements
Post-Elicitation	Implementation and Continuous Improvement	Requirement traceability and ongoing refinement

Table 1: Framework Overview

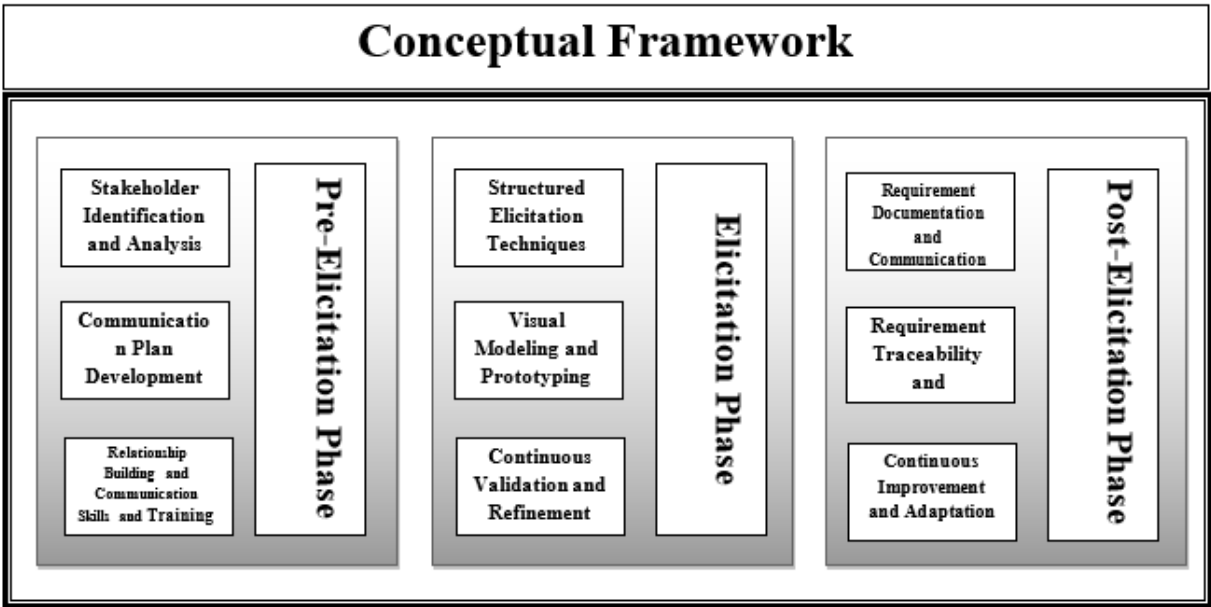


Figure 1: Conceptual Framework

1.1 Structure of the Framework

It is structured to guide organizations through a comprehensive process of stakeholder engagement, communication, and requirement management across the entire lifecycle of a project. It is divided into three key phases: Pre-Elicitation, Elicitation, and Post-Elicitation. Each phase plays a crucial role in ensuring that requirements are effectively gathered, validated, communicated, and managed.

1.2 Three Core Phases

1. *Pre-Elicitation Phase*: Preparation and stakeholder analysis

2. **Elicitation Phase:** Active requirements gathering and documentation
3. **Post-Elicitation Phase:** Validation, documentation, and continuous improvement

Phase 1: Pre-Elicitation - Setting the Foundation - (*Pre-Elicitation Phase - Weeks 4-6*)

Goal: To align mindsets and set up the communication infrastructure before any requirements are gathered.

The Pre-Elicitation Phase concentrates on the preparation of the organization, parties involved, and units for coordinated teamwork, aimed at collaboration readiness. This stage is considered a preparation stage, where the foundation for optimal requirements retrieval is set. This phase concerns the formalization of the communication strategies, participation of the stakeholders, adjustments of the teams, and alignment of your team with the stakeholders' stream, ensuring everyone is notified and totally equipped for the elicitation phase.

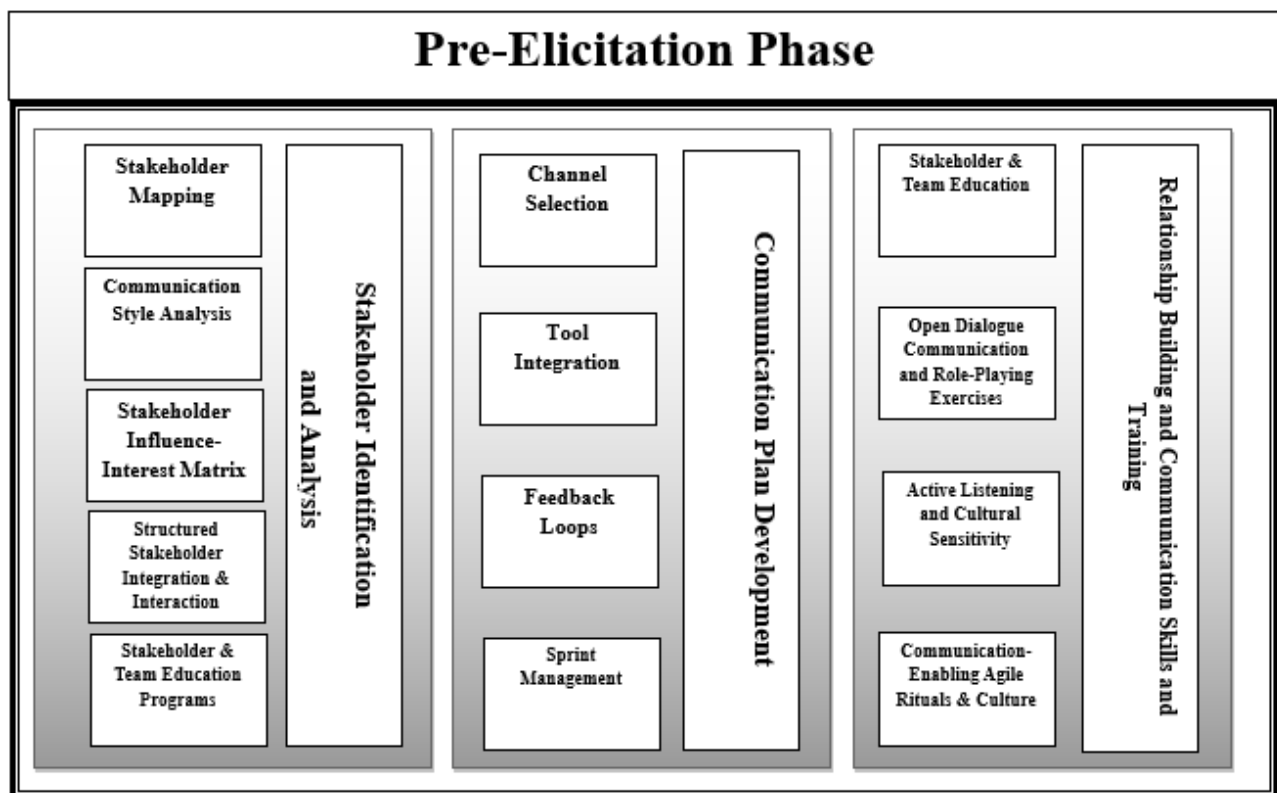


Figure 2: Pre-Elicitation Phase

Key Activities

1.2.1.1 *Stakeholder Identification and Analysis*

Identify all stakeholders involved in the project, including internal and external parties.

1. *Stakeholder Mapping:*

Activity:

- Identify all individuals and groups who will be affected by or have influence on the project

- Create a comprehensive list of internal stakeholders (team members, departments) and external stakeholders (clients, vendors, end-users)
- Document the role and responsibilities of each stakeholder
- Understand organizational hierarchy and reporting relationships

Process:

1. Conduct discovery meetings with project sponsors and leadership
2. Document stakeholder details including name, title, department, and contact information
3. Identify stakeholder motivations and concerns
4. Create a living stakeholder register that you'll update throughout the project.

Outcome:

- Stakeholders register with complete contact information
- Department and role mapping
- Stakeholder Profile Documentation

2. Communication Style Analysis:

Activity:

- Assess how each stakeholder prefers to communicate (email, meetings, calls, instant messaging)
- Understand cultural and linguistic considerations within your stakeholder group
- Document communication frequency preferences and availability
- Identify any communication barriers or sensitivities

Process:

1. Conduct brief one-on-one interviews or surveys with key stakeholders
2. Ask about communication preferences and best times to reach them
3. Note any accessibility requirements or communication needs
4. Document language preferences and technical comfort levels

Outcome:

- Communication preferences matrix
- Cultural sensitivity notes
- Accessibility requirements documentation

3. Stakeholder Influence-Interest Matrix

Activity:

- Assess each stakeholder's level of influence on the project
- Measure their level of interest in project outcomes
- Categorize stakeholders to determine appropriate engagement strategies
- Create a visual matrix to guide your engagement approach

Process:

1. Rate each stakeholder on a scale (1-5) for influence and interest
2. Plot stakeholders on a 2x2 matrix with four quadrants:
 - High Influence, High Interest: Manage closely with regular communication
 - High Influence, Low Interest: Keep satisfied with strategic updates
 - Low Influence, High Interest: Keep informed with regular updates
 - Low Influence, Low Interest: Monitor with minimal engagement

Stakeholder	Influence (1-5)	Interest (1-5)	Quadrant	Action Plan
Example Stakeholder			High Influence, High Interest	Manage closely with regular communication
Example Stakeholder			High Influence, Low Interest	Keep satisfied with strategic updates
Example Stakeholder			Low Influence, High Interest	Keep informed with regular updates
Example Stakeholder			Low Influence, Low Interest	Monitor with minimal engagement

Table 2: 2x2 matrix for Stakeholder Influence and Interest

Rating Scale:

Influence: How much power the stakeholder has over the project (1 = low, 5 = high)

Interest: How much the stakeholder cares about the project's outcome (1 = low, 5 = high)

This table provides an opportunity to evaluate each stakeholder's impact and level of interest, map them to the appropriate quadrant, and implement the appropriate action plan.

Outcome:

- Visual Influence-Interest Matrix
- Engagement strategy by stakeholder category
- Communication plan template

4. Structured Stakeholder Integration & Interaction

Activity:

- Design structured interaction sessions that bring stakeholders together
- Create formats for collaborative work sessions
- Plan for cross-functional team building
- Establish governance structures for decision-making

Process:

1. Schedule kickoff meetings with all stakeholder groups
2. Organize working sessions with representatives from each department
3. Create cross-functional teams for specific work areas
4. Establish steering committees or review boards if needed
5. Define decision-making authorities and escalation paths

Outcome:

- Kickoff meeting agenda and materials
- Working group structure and schedules
- Governance framework documentation

5. Stakeholder & Team Education Programs

Activity:

- Develop training programs to ensure stakeholders and team members understand the framework
- Create educational materials about the project goals and scope
- Prepare everyone for their roles in the elicitation process
- Build team competency in the framework methodology

Process:

1. Create training curriculum covering:
 - Framework overview and objectives
 - Roles and responsibilities
 - Tools and techniques to be used
 - Expected timelines and deliverables
2. Conduct training sessions (workshops or webinars)
3. Provide documentation and reference materials
4. Schedule Q&A sessions for clarification
5. Measure training effectiveness through assessments

Outcome:

- Training materials and presentations
- Training schedule and attendance records
- Competency assessment results
- FAQ documentation

Step	Action	Tools/Techniques	Expected Outcome
Stakeholder Mapping	List of all individuals/groups affected by the project	Stakeholder Register Template	Comprehensive stakeholder list
Communication Style Analysis	Assess how each stakeholder prefers to communicate	Communication Style Questionnaire	Tailored communication approaches
Stakeholder Influence-Interest Matrix	Plot stakeholders on power vs. interest grid	2x2 Matrix Template	Prioritized stakeholder engagement strategy
Structured Stakeholder Integration & Interaction	Plan how stakeholders will be involved in each phase	Integration Schedule Template	Clear stakeholder involvement roadmap
Stakeholder & Team Education Programs	Train stakeholders and team on Agile processes	Training Materials, Workshops	Increased understanding and alignment

Table 3: Activity chart of Stakeholder Identification and Analysis

1.2.1.2 Communication Plan Development

Develop a comprehensive communication plan based on stakeholder analysis.

1. Channel Selection and Tool Integration:

Activity:

- Select appropriate communication channels and technologies for your stakeholder base
- Integrate tools that will support the framework implementation
- Ensure all stakeholders have access to required tools
- Create documentation for tool usage

Process:

1. Assess available communication technologies (Slack, Teams, Jira, etc.)
2. Match tools to stakeholder needs and technical capability

3. Conduct tool training and user acceptance testing
4. Create user guides and quick reference cards
5. Establish support mechanisms for tool issues

Outcome:

- Tool selection matrix
- Tool usage guidelines
- Support contact information
- Integration checklist

2. Feedback Loops:

Activity:

- Establish mechanisms for collecting continuous feedback during the elicitation process
- Create feedback collection methods that will be used during requirements gathering activities
- Set up feedback review and action processes
- Plan for iterative refinement of requirements based on collected feedback
- Prepare team and stakeholders for systematic feedback collection

Process:

1. Design Feedback Collection Tools and Templates
2. Establish Feedback Channels and Communication Mechanisms
3. Define Feedback Review Schedule and Process
4. Create Action Processes for Responding to Feedback
5. Document Feedback Tracking and Logging Procedures
6. Prepare Team for Feedback Collection and Analysis
7. Set Up Feedback Logging and Reporting Systems

Outcome:

- Feedback Collection Templates and Tools
- Feedback Management Process Documentation
- Feedback Channel Definitions and Protocols
- Feedback Tracking and Logging Procedures
- Stakeholder Communication Plan for Feedback Mechanisms
- Schedule for Feedback Collection and Review Activities

Step	Description	Activities
1. Design Feedback Collection Tools and Templates	Develop tools for feedback collection and templates.	- Create survey templates (5-7 questions) for post-workshop and general feedback. - Design simple feedback forms for ad-hoc submissions. - Develop check-in meeting agenda templates. - Create feedback log template with standardized fields. - Design feedback analysis template for synthesizing themes.
2. Establish Feedback Channels and Communication Mechanisms	Set up various communication channels for feedback.	- Identify multiple feedback channels (email, Teams/Slack, survey tools, one-on-ones). - Configure communication tools with feedback-specific channels. - Establish feedback email alias or submission portal. - Define access permissions and notification settings - Designate feedback point of contact.

3. Define Feedback Review Schedule and Process	Create a structured schedule for reviewing feedback.	- Schedule daily feedback channel monitoring. - Plan weekly synthesis meeting (1 hour) to review collected feedback. - Establish bi-weekly feedback sessions during sprint reviews. - Create regular reporting cadence. - Identify feedback review owner.
4. Create Action Processes for Responding to Feedback	Develop processes for acting on feedback and prioritizing.	- Define feedback triage process to categorize incoming feedback (Clarification requests, Requirement additions, etc.). - Establish response time commitments (24-48 hours typical). - Create escalation path for urgent feedback. - Document how feedback will be communicated back to stakeholders.
5. Document Feedback Tracking and Logging Procedures	Set up systems and processes for tracking feedback.	- Set up feedback tracking system (spreadsheet, Jira, or dedicated tool). - Define feedback data fields (ID, date, stakeholder, category, description, priority, action, status) - Create feedback logging procedures manual. - Establish naming/numbering convention (FBK-001, FBK-002, etc.). - Define data retention policy. - Set up automated reminders for overdue items.
6. Prepare Team for Feedback Collection and Analysis	Train the team on effective feedback collection.	- Conduct 1-hour training on feedback collection best practices. - Teach active listening and clarification techniques. - Role-play handling difficult or conflicting feedback. - Review feedback templates and categorization. - Discuss feedback analysis approach. - Assign primary and backup feedback owners.
7. Set Up Feedback Logging and Reporting Systems	Configure tools for tracking, logging, and reporting feedback.	- Configure feedback database with all required fields - Create feedback dashboard showing volume, categories, and status. - Design weekly feedback summary report. - Set up automated notifications for new feedback. - Test all systems before elicitation begins. - Create user guides for teams and stakeholders.

Table 4: Activity Table for Feed Loop

Component	What to Define	Example
Channel Selection	Preferred communication methods for different scenarios	- Formal decisions: Email + Meeting - Quick updates: Slack/Teams - Feedback: JIRA comments
Tool Integration	Technology stack for communication	- Project Management: JIRA/Asana - Documentation: Confluence - Meetings: Zoom/MS Teams
Feedback Loops	How and when feedback will be collected	- Daily standups - Sprint reviews every 2 weeks - Monthly stakeholder check-ins
Risk Management Planning	Communication-related risks and mitigation	- Risk: Key stakeholder unavailable - Mitigation: Designate backup decision-maker

Table 5: Activity of Communication Plan Development

1.2.1.3 Relationship Building and Communication Skills Training

Train the team in communication and relationship-building skills to improve stakeholder engagement.

1. Stakeholder & Team Education Programs

Activity:

- Design and Deliver Training Programs

Process:

1. Conduct Training Needs Assessment
2. Develop Training Content by Audience
3. Design Training Delivery
4. Schedule Training Sessions
5. Conduct Training
6. Post-Training Support

Outcome:

- Training needs assessment report
- Training agenda for each audience
- Presentation slide decks
- Participant workbooks and handouts
- Training recordings
- FAQ document
- Attendance roster and certificates
- Post-training feedback results

2. Open Dialogue, Role-Playing Exercises, and Active Listening

Activity:

- Create forums for open, non-judgmental communication
- Use role-playing to explore different perspectives and scenarios
- Practice active listening to ensure understanding
- Address cultural differences and sensitivities

Process:

1. Facilitate workshops that encourage open discussion
2. Conduct role-playing exercises where participants adopt different perspectives
3. Practice paraphrasing and clarification techniques
4. Use silence and reflection strategically in conversations
5. Document agreements and decisions that emerge from dialogue

Outcome:

- Workshop facilitation notes
- Documented agreements and decisions
- Participant feedback and insights
- Clarified assumptions and scope

3. Communication-Enabling Agile Rituals & Culture

Activity:

- Establish agile ceremonies and rituals that enhance communication

- Create a collaborative culture that values transparency
- Use agile practices to keep communication flowing
- Align team rituals with framework objectives

Process:

1. Conduct daily standups focused on requirement clarification
2. Hold regular sprint planning sessions with stakeholder input
3. Organize sprint review sessions for stakeholder feedback
4. Facilitate retrospectives focused on communication improvements
5. Create shared team spaces (physical or virtual) for collaboration

Outcome:

- Agile ceremonies schedule
- Facilitation guides for each ceremony
- Meeting notes and action items
- Culture evolution documentation

1.2.2 Phase 2: Elicitation - Active Requirement Gathering

Goal: To capture comprehensive requirements using a mix of AI-augmented and traditional techniques.

The core phase for gathering and refining requirements using diverse techniques. The Elicitation Phase is where active requirements gathering occurs. This phase combines structured techniques, AI-augmented methods, visual modeling, and continuous validation to ensure comprehensive and accurate requirements capture.

Elicitation Phase is divided into three main phases:

1. **Structures Elicitation Techniques:** Use various elicitation methods to gather requirements from stakeholders
2. **Visual Modeling and Prototyping:** Develop visual models and prototypes to better understand stakeholder requirements.
3. **Continuous Validation and Refinement:** This includes business value-based backlog prioritization with stakeholder negotiation and scope control, structured stakeholder feedback and change request management, strong quality practices through requirements management and expectations setting, comprehensive testing covering beta, end-to-end, security, compliance and performance, and close agile coordination through sprint planning, reviews, team collaboration, and project management alignment.

Key Activities

1.2.2.1 Structures Elicitation Techniques

Use various elicitation methods to gather requirements from stakeholders.

Employ a mix of methods:

- Traditional: Interviews and Surveys, Workshops, Focus Groups, Observation.
- AI-Augmented: AI Chatbots, AI-Assisted Proposal Writing, AI Tools for Requirements.
- Additional: Multi-faceted Communication, Demo Sessions, Structured/Ad-hoc Meetings, Communication Mechanisms.

Activity:

- Use various elicitation methods to gather requirements from stakeholders.

Process:

1. Interviews and Surveys: Organize one-on-one or group interviews and surveys with key stakeholders to gather their insights and expectations.
2. Workshops and Focus Groups: Host interactive sessions with diverse groups of stakeholders to discuss needs, constraints, and priorities.
3. Observation: Observe stakeholder processes to identify pain points or improvement areas.

Outcome:

- A set of collected requirements and insights from stakeholders

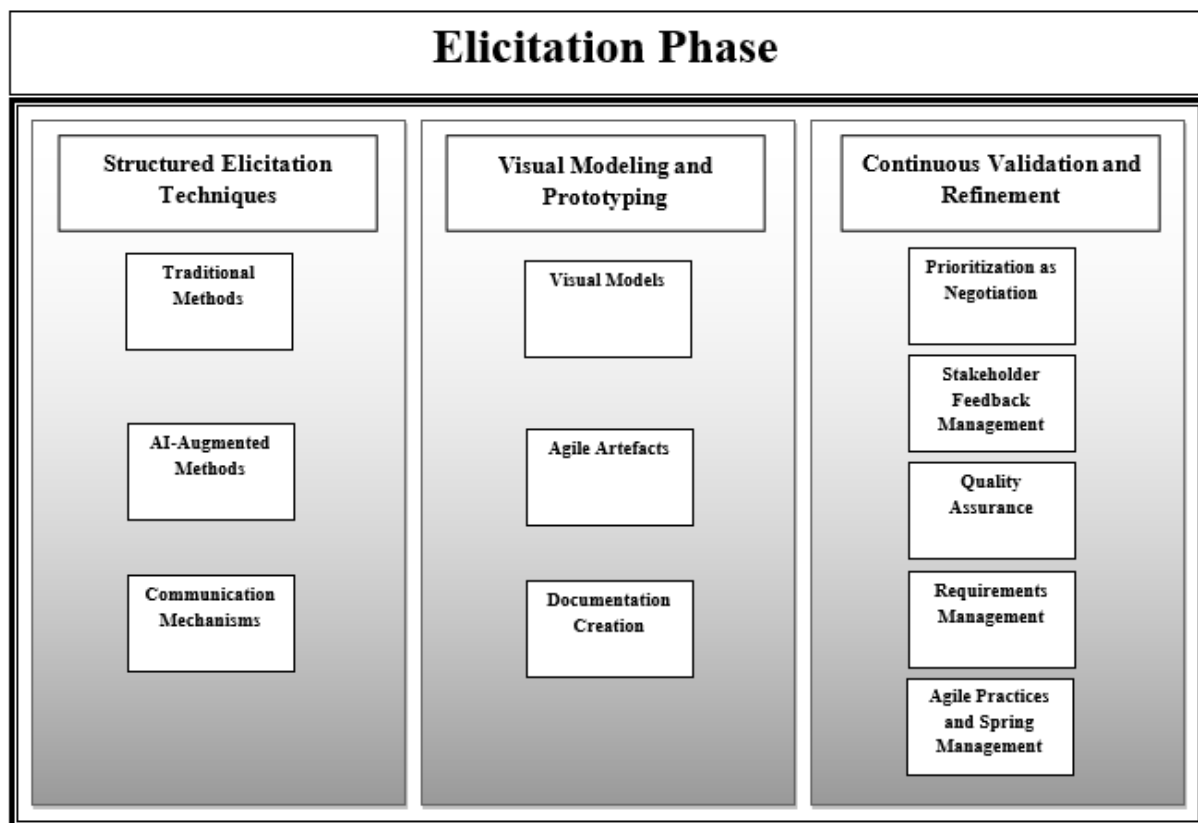


Figure 3: Elicitation Phase

Activities

1. Traditional Methods

1.1 Interviews and Surveys

- Conduct one-on-one or small group interviews with stakeholders
- Ask open-ended and probing questions to understand needs
- Document responses systematically
- Follow up to clarify ambiguities

1.2 Workshops and Focus Groups

- Organize facilitated group sessions

- Use brainstorming techniques to generate ideas
- Facilitate discussions around key requirements areas
- Build consensus on priorities and approaches

1.3 Observation

- Observe current processes and user behaviors
- Document pain points and workarounds
- Understand context and environment
- Identify unstated requirements

Technique	Best For	Effort	Coverage
Interviews	Deep understanding	Medium	Focused
Workshops	Group alignment	High	Broad
Focus Groups	Specific topics	Medium	Targeted
Observation	Workflow understanding	High	Real-world
Surveys	Broad input	Low	Extensive
Demo Sessions	Visual feedback	Medium	Specific

Table 6: Elicitation Techniques

2. AI-Augmented Methods

Activity:

- Enhance the elicitation process using AI tools.

Process:

2.1 AI Chatbots:

- Deploy chatbots to gather initial requirements from stakeholders
- Use for 24/7 requirement clarification
- Screen and categorize common questions
- Pre-process information before human review

2.2 AI-Assisted Proposal Writing

- Use AI tools to draft requirements based on stakeholder input
- Generate first drafts of user stories and acceptance criteria
- Ensure consistency in documentation format
- Speed up documentation creation process

2.3 AI Tools for Requirements:

- Use AI-powered tools to capture, store, and analyze requirements data.

Outcome:

- Enhanced accuracy and efficiency in gathering and managing requirements.

AI Tool Type	How to Use	Example Implementation
AI Chatbots	Initial requirement gathering	Implement chatbot on project portal for 24/7 requirement submission
AI-Assisted Proposal Writing	Help stakeholders articulate needs	Use AI to convert informal requests into structured user stories
AI Tools for Analysis	Analyze requirements for gaps and conflicts	Implement tools that flag contradictory requirements

Table 7: AI Tools

Activities

3. Communication Mechanisms:

Use multi-faceted approach (mix of methods), scheduling regular demo sessions and maintaining both structured and ad-hoc communication channels

Activity:

- Leverage multiple communication channels simultaneously
- Use text, voice, and video for richer communication
- Ensure accessibility for diverse stakeholders' needs
- Maintain comprehensive audit trails

Process:

1. Select appropriate elicitation techniques based on stakeholder needs
2. Prepare materials and tools for each technique
3. Schedule sessions with stakeholders
4. Document all findings systematically
5. Review and validate captured information with stakeholders
6. Identify gaps and plan follow-up sessions

3.1 Demo Sessions

- Showcase existing solutions or prototypes
- Gather feedback on functionality and design
- Identify gaps and desired improvements
- Build stakeholder buy-in through visualization

3.2 Structured/Ad-hoc Meetings

- Schedule regular meetings with defined agendas
- Hold spontaneous sessions when issues arise
- Maintain focus on requirements and outcomes
- Document decisions and action items

Outcome:

- Interview transcripts and notes
- Survey results and analysis
- Workshop outcomes and decisions
- Observation reports
- AI-generated draft requirements

- Multi-channel communication records

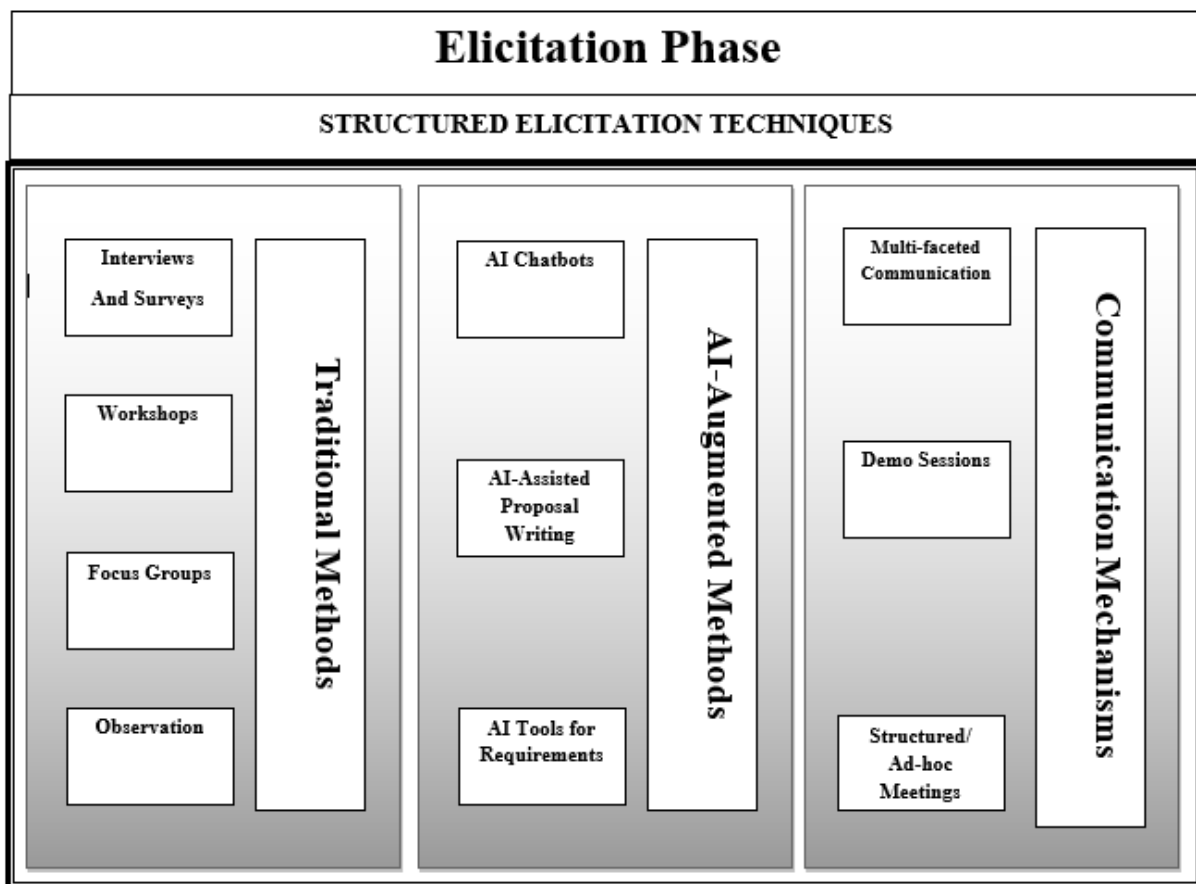


Figure 4: Elicitation Phase: Structured Elicitation Techniques

1.2.2.2 Visual Modeling and Prototyping

Create tangible representations:

Use Cases, Prototyping, User Stories and Scenarios.

Supporting elements: Visual Models, User Stories as "Single Source of Truth", Acceptance Criteria, Project Glossaries, Agile Artefacts, BRD/FSD Integration, Traceability Matrices, Risk Documentation

Model Type	Purpose	Recommended Tool
Use Cases	Document system interactions	Draw.io, Lucidchart
User Stories	Capture user needs in Agile format	JIRA, Trello, Azure DevOps
Prototypes	Visualize proposed solutions	Figma, Adobe XD, Sketch
Flowcharts	Map business processes	Visio, diagrams.net

Table 8: Activities in Visual Modeling

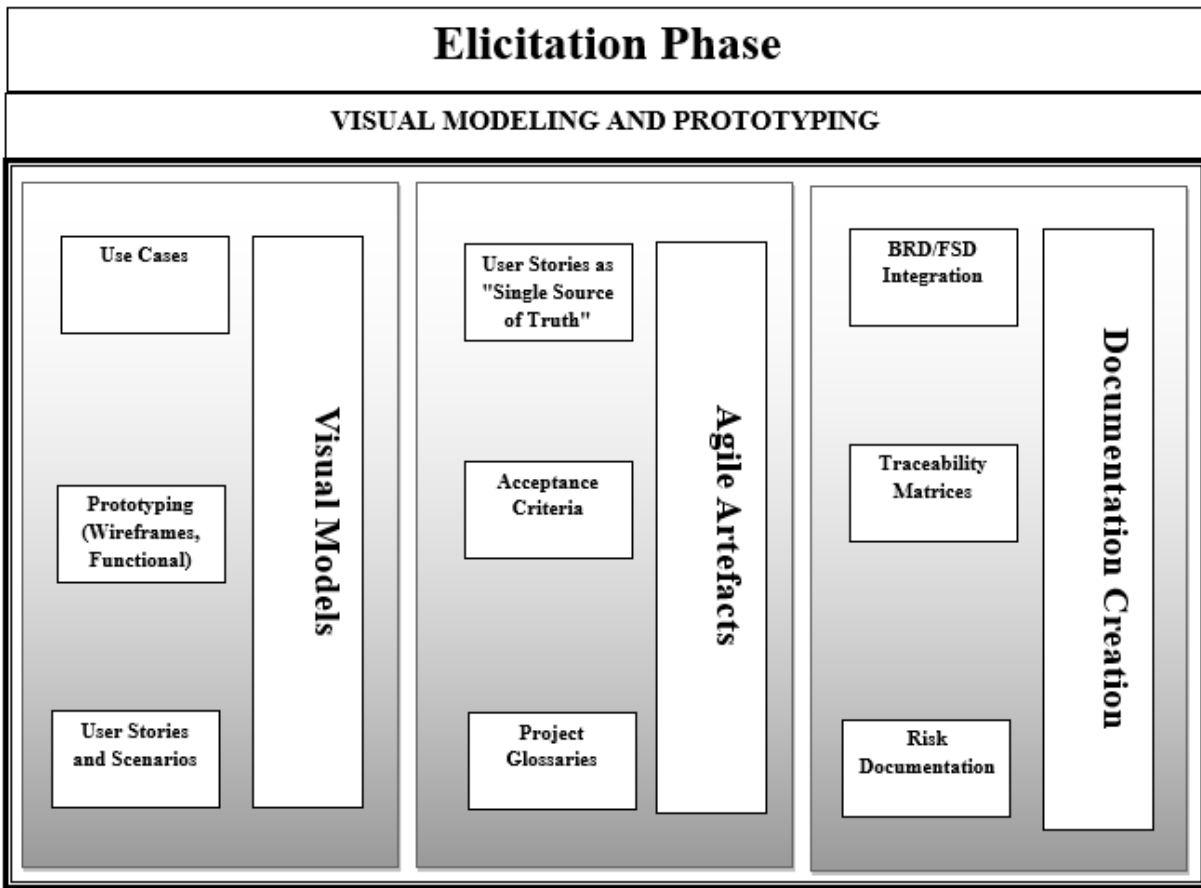


Figure 5: Elicitation Phase: Visual Modeling and Prototyping

1. *Visual Models (Diagrams, Flowcharts, Models)*

- Create process flows showing current and future states
- Develop system architecture diagrams
- Document data flows and integrations
- Use standard modeling notations (UML, BPMN, etc.)

Activity:

1. Select visual modeling approach based on requirements complexity
2. Create initial models/prototypes based on elicitation findings
3. Review with stakeholders and incorporate feedback
4. Iterate on designs until stakeholder consensus
5. Use as reference for detailed documentation

Process:

- Create visual representations of requirements and solutions
- Develop prototypes that stakeholders can interact with
- Use visual models to clarify complex concepts
- Ensure common understanding through visual communication

1.1 Use Cases

- Document on how users will interact with the system
- Include actors, pre-conditioners, main flow, and alternative flows
- Validate use cases with stakeholders
- Use as basis for test planning

1.2 User Stories and Scenarios

- Write user stories in the format: "As a [role], I want to [action], so that [benefit]"
- Develop detailed scenarios for each story
- Include happy paths and exception paths
- Attach acceptance criteria to each story

1.3 Prototyping (Wireframes and Functional Prototypes)

- Create low-fidelity wireframes for layout and structure
- Develop higher-fidelity mockups for visual design
- Build interactive prototypes for user interaction testing
- Validate design decisions with stakeholders

Outcome:

- Use case documentation
- User stories with acceptance criteria
- Wireframes and prototype designs
- Visual models and diagrams
- Validation sign-off from stakeholders

2. Agile Artefacts

User Stories and Acceptance Criteria as a single source of truth. Project Glossaries and standardized documentation.

Activity

- User Stories Format: "As a [user], I want to [action] so that [benefit]"
- Acceptance Criteria: List specific, testable conditions for completion
- Project Glossary: Maintain shared terminology document
- Update Protocol: All changes go through agreed channels

Process:

2.1 User Stories as "Single Source of Truth"

- User Stories as "Single Source of Truth"
- Position user stories as the primary requirement unit
- Keep stories concise but complete
- Link stories to higher-level business objectives
- Use stories to drive development work

2.2 Acceptance Criteria

- Define clear, testable acceptance criteria for each story
- Include both functional and non-functional criteria
- Ensure criteria are understandable by all team members
- Use criteria for quality validation

2.3 Project Glossary

- Document key terms and definitions
- Include acronyms and technical terminology
- Ensure consistent language across all documentation
- Make it accessible to all stakeholders

Outcome:

- User Stories & Acceptance Criteria as "single source of truth"
- Project glossaries and standardized documentation
- Visual aids to capture, clarify, and communicate requirements

3. Documentation Creation

Maintain thorough and traceable documentation throughout the elicitation process.

Activity:

- **BRD/FSD Integration:** Integrate Business Requirement Documents (BRD) and Functional Specification Documents (FSD) to ensure comprehensive documentation.
- **Traceability Matrices:** Develop matrices to track requirements from identification through development.
- **Risk documentation:** It identifies and tracks project risks through unique risk identifiers, descriptions of what could go wrong, probability assessments, impact levels, and risk scores (Probability × Impact). Each risk includes a mitigation strategy, contingency plan, risk owner, and current status (Active, Mitigated, Closed). Typical risks include requirement ambiguity, scope creep, stakeholder unavailability, technical complexity, resource constraints, and changing business needs.

Process:

1. Define documentation standards and templates
2. Assign documentation responsibilities
3. Create initial draft documents from elicitation findings
4. Review and validate with stakeholders
5. Maintain living documentation throughout project
6. Version control all documents

3.1 Business Requirements Document (BRD) / Functional Specification Document (FSD)

- Create high-level business requirements documentation
- Develop detailed functional specifications for complex features
- Maintain alignment between BRD, FSD, and user stories
- Use for stakeholder communication and validation

3.2 Traceability Matrices

- Link requirements to business objectives
- Trace requirements to design and test cases
- Ensure all requirements are addressed
- Maintain traceability throughout project lifecycle

Req ID	User Story	Acceptance Criteria	Prototype Link	Use Case Diagram	Test Scenario	Sprint Allocation	Business Value
RQ-001	"As a new user, I want to register using Facebook/Google so that I can sign up quickly"	1. Registration button visible 2. Social media authentication works 3. Profile created with basic info	[Prototype-v1.2]	UC-003	TS-015	Sprint 3	8/10
RQ-002	"As a system admin, I need the system to handle 1000 TPM so that we can scale for peak loads"	1. Load test passes 2. Response time < 2s 3. No data loss during peak	-	UC-007	TS-042	Sprint 5	9/10
RQ-003	"As a manager, I want real-time dashboard updates so that I can make timely decisions"	1. Data updates within 30s 2. Charts refresh automatically 3. Historical data accessible	[Dashboard-Prototype]	UC-012	TS-028	Sprint 4	7/10
RQ-004	"As a user, I want GDPR-compliant data handling so that my privacy is protected"	1. Data consent obtained 2. Right to be forgotten implemented 3. Data encryption in transit	-	UC-019	TS-053	Sprint 2	10/10
RQ-005	"As a mobile user, I want offline functionality so that I can work without internet"	1. App loads without internet 2. Data syncs when online 3. No data loss during sync	[Mobile-Offline-Mockup]	UC-025	TS-067	Sprint 6	6/10

Table 9: Sample: Requirement to Artefact Traceability

ID	What	Why	Who	When	Status	Links To
F-001	Social Login	Increase registrations by 20%	Marketing	Sprint 3	 In Progress	US-003, TC-015, RISK-007
F-002	System Scaling	Handle peak loads	Operations	Sprint 5	 Planned	US-012, TC-042, RISK-012
F-003	Real-time Dashboard	Enable timely decisions	Management	Sprint 4	 60% Complete	US-007, TC-028, RISK-015
F-004	GDPR Compliance	Legal requirement	Legal	Sprint 2	☒ Accepted	US-019, TC-053, RISK-003
F-005	Offline Mobile	Working without internet	Field Staff	Sprint 6	 Backlog	US-025, TC-067, RISK-020

Table 10: Sample: Agile Traceability Matrix (Lightweight)

Status Icons:

-  Planned
-  Ready
-  In Progress
-  Testing
-  Complete
- ☒ Accepted
-  Blocked

3.3 Risk Documentation:

- Identify and document requirement-related risks
- Assess risk probability and impact
- Develop mitigation strategies
- Monitor risks throughout the project

Probability Level	Description	Numerical Value	Impact Level	Description	Numerical Value
Very Low (VL)	Rare, unlikely to occur	1	Very Low (VL)	Minimal impact; negligible consequences	1
Low (L)	Possible but not likely	2	Low (L)	Minor impact; easily managed	2
Medium (M)	As likely as not to occur	3	Medium (M)	Moderate impact; requires attention	3
High (H)	Likely to occur	4	High (H)	Significant impact; affects project objectives	4
Very High (VH)	Almost certain to occur	5	Very High (VH)	Critical impact; threatens project viability	5

Table 11: Format: Risk Score Calculation (Probability × Impact)

Probability/Impact	VL (1)	L (2)	M (3)	H (4)	VH (5)
VL (1)	1	2	3	4	5
L (2)	2	4	6	8	10
M (3)	3	6	9	12	15
H (4)	4	8	12	16	20
VH (5)	5	10	15	20	25

Table 12: Sample: Risk Score Calculation (Probability × Impact)

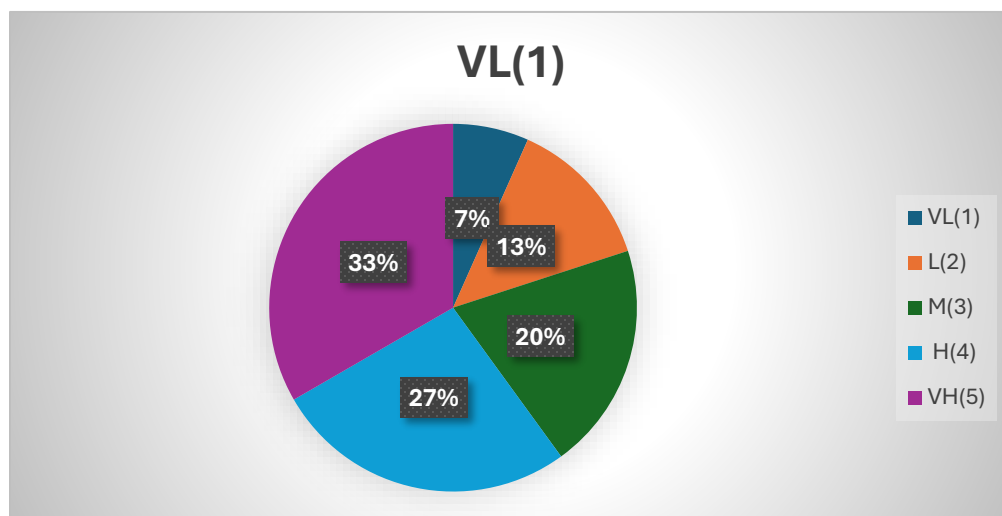


Figure 6: Sample Chart: Outcome

Risk Score Range	Priority Level	Action Required
1-3	Low Priority	Monitor; no immediate action
4-9	Medium Priority	Plan mitigation within current sprint
10-16	High Priority	Immediate action; escalate to stakeholders
17-25	Critical Priority	Emergency response; may require project replanning

Table 13: Risk Priority Categories

Status	Description	Actions Required	Review Frequency	Documentation Needs
Identified	Risk has been recognized but not analyzed	• Log in risk register • Assign preliminary owner • Schedule analysis	Weekly	Initial risk log entry
Analyzed	Probability and impact assessed	• Complete risk assessment • Calculate risk score • Determine priority	Weekly	Updated with probability/impact scores
Mitigation Planned	Action plan developed	• Define mitigation strategy • Assign resources • Set timeline	Daily in standups	Mitigation plan document
Active Mitigation	Mitigation actions in progress	• Execute mitigation plan • Monitor effectiveness • Report progress	Daily	Progress updates, change logs
Contingency Active	Risk occurred, using backup plan	• Implement contingency plan • Manage consequences • Communicate to stakeholders	Hourly/Daily	Incident reports, communication logs
Mitigated	Risk reduced to acceptable level	• Verify mitigation effectiveness • Update lessons learned • Archive documentation	Once at closure	Final mitigation report
Closed	Risk no longer applicable	• Formal closure approval • Archive complete record • Share lessons learned	Once at closure	Closure certificate, archive
Transferred	Risk ownership moved to another party	• Update risk owner • Transfer documentation • Establish communication channel	Monthly	Transfer agreement, updated register
Accepted	Risk acknowledged but no action taken	• Document acceptance rationale • Monitor for changes • Stakeholder sign-off	Monthly	Acceptance justification document

Table 14: Risk Status Definitions

Status	Color Code	Dashboard Indicator
Identified, Analyzed	○ White/Gray	"Planned/Under Review"

Mitigation Planned	 Blue	"Ready for Action"
Active Mitigation	 Yellow	"In Progress"
Contingency Active	 Orange	"Emergency Active"
Mitigated, Transferred, Accepted	 Green	"Under Control"
Closed	 Black/Gray	"Completed"

Table 15: Status Color Coding for Visual Management

Risk ID	Risk Category	Risk Description	Probability	Impact	Risk Score	Status	Owner	Mitigation Strategy	Date Identified
RISK-007	Communication	Key stakeholder unavailable for requirement validation	Medium (3)	High (4)	12 (High)	Active Mitigation	Product Owner	1. Designate backup decision-maker 2. Record requirements for async review 3. Weekly catch-up meetings	2025-01-15

Table 16: Integration Example in Risk Register

Output:

- Complete user story backlog with acceptance criteria
- BRD and FSD documents
- Project glossary
- Risk register
- Traceability matrices
- Documentation templates and guidelines

1.2.2.3 Continuous Validation and Refinement

Continuously validate and refine requirements based on evolving stakeholder needs.

Activity:

- Validate requirements continuously with stakeholders
- Refine requirements based on feedback and new information
- Ensure requirements remain aligned with business objectives
- Manage scope and prevent scope creep
- Business Value-Based Prioritization via negotiation, Backlog priority management, Product owner-stakeholder negotiations, Scope creep management.
- Stakeholder Feedback Management, Change request handling, daily new request management.
- Quality practices: Requirements Management, Understanding requirements gaps, Requirement volatility management, Stakeholder expectation setting.
- Testing: Beta version testing, End-to-end testing, Security and compliance checks, Performance testing.

- Agile coordination: Sprint planning and reviews, Team collaboration practices, Project management coordination.

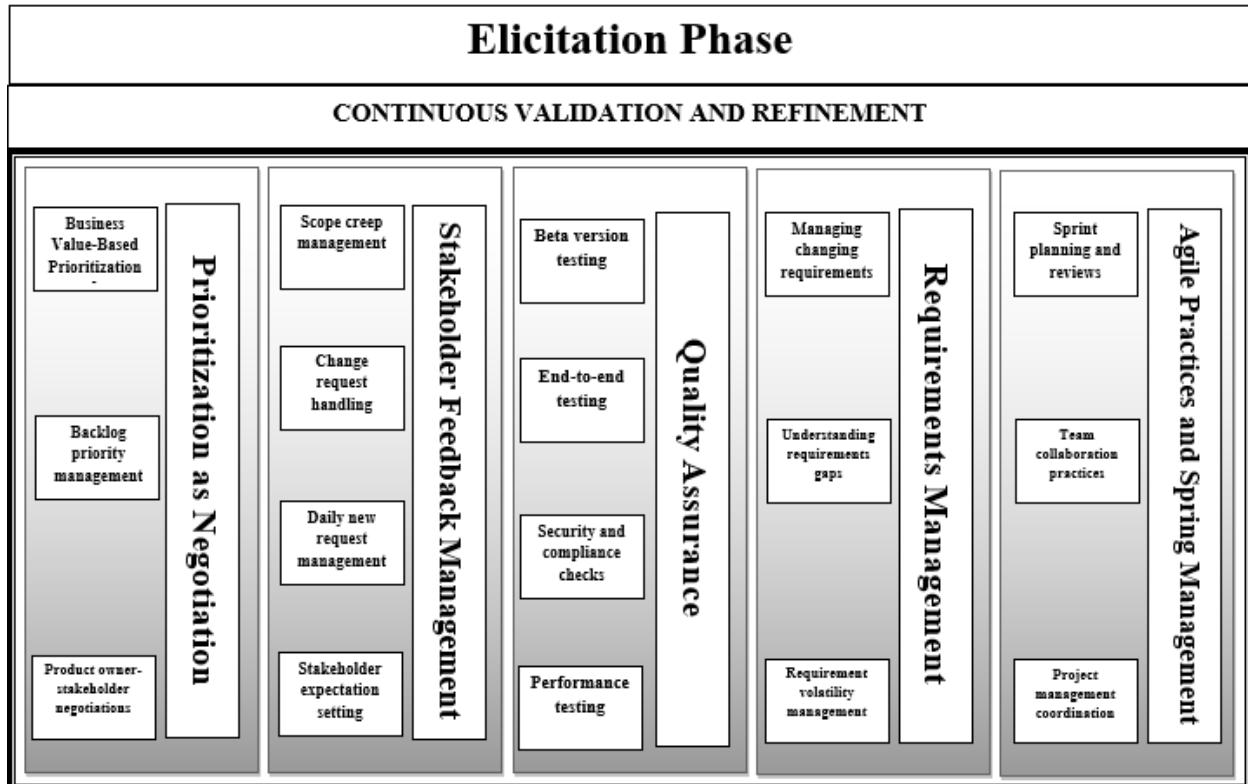


Figure 7: Elicitation Phase: Continuous Validation and Refinement

Process:

1. *Prioritization as Negotiation*

1. **Business Value Assessment:** Rate each requirement (1-10)
2. **Effort Estimation:** Development team estimates complexity
3. **Negotiation Session:** Product Owner, team, stakeholders discuss
4. **Backlog Grooming:** Regular refinement of priorities
5. **Multi-faceted Communication:** Use a mix of 1-on-1 interviews and group workshops to resolve conflicting requirements.
6. **Prioritization:** Use the MoSCoW method (Must-have, Should-have, Could-have, Won't-have) to define the **MVP (Minimum Viable Product)**.

1.1 *Business Value-Based Prioritization*

- Assess each requirement's business value
- Consider strategic alignment and dependencies
- Prioritize based on value delivery
- Adjust priorities such as business context changes

1.2 *Backlog Priority Management*

- Maintain prioritized product backlog

- Review and adjust priorities regularly
- Address competing priorities
- Communicate priority rationale to stakeholders

1.3 Product Owner-Stakeholder Negotiations

- Facilitate discussions around conflicting priorities
- Help stakeholders understand trade-offs
- Build consensus on final priorities
- Document priority decisions and rationale

Outcome:

- Recognize that prioritization involves discussion and compromise
- Use data and business value to guide decisions
- Ensure all stakeholder voices are heard
- Create shared ownership of final priorities

Requirement	Business Value	Effort	Priority Score	Notes
Login Feature	9	3	27	Critical for MVP
Advanced Search	7	8	0.875	Post-MVP
Report Export	8	5	1.6	High business value

Table 15: Sample Prioritization Matrix

2. Stakeholder Feedback Management

2.1 Scope Creep Management

- Define clear project scope boundaries
- Screen new requirements against scope
- Use control process for out-of-scope items
- Communicate scope decisions clearly

2.2 Change Request Handling

- Establish formal change control process
- Evaluate change impact on schedule and resources
- Assess strategic value and cost-benefit
- Document all change decisions

2.3 Daily New Request Management

- Screen new requests as they arrive
- Determine if requests represent scope additions or clarifications
- Route to appropriate decision authority
- Maintain backlog in prioritized order

2.4 Stakeholder Expectation Setting

- Clearly communicate what will and will not be delivered
- Discuss timeline and resource constraints
- Set realistic expectations for quality and functionality
- Address stakeholder concerns proactively

Outcome:

- Create regular opportunities for stakeholder feedback
- Document all feedback systematically
- Analyze feedback for patterns and themes
- Communicate how feedback will be addressed

3. *Quality Assurance***Activity:**

- Define quality criteria for requirements
- Review requirements for completeness and clarity
- Validate requirements against acceptance criteria
- Ensure traceability to business objectives

Process

1. Establish validation and refinement schedule
2. Conduct regular review sessions with stakeholders
3. Implement feedback collection mechanisms
4. Create and maintain prioritized backlog
5. Manage change requests through established process
6. Monitor scope and manage scope creep
7. Conduct quality reviews at key points
8. Test assumptions through beta versions and user testing

3.1 *Beta Version Testing*

- Deploy early versions to select stakeholders
- Gather feedback on functionality and usability
- Identify and resolve issues before full release
- Build stakeholder confidence through involvement

3.2 *End-to-End Testing*

- Test complete workflows from start to finish
- Validate integration between components
- Test with realistic data and scenarios
- Involving stakeholders in test planning and execution

3.3 *Security and Compliance Checks*

- Review requirements for security implications
- Ensure compliance with regulatory requirements
- Identify required security and compliance measures
- Document security and compliance decisions

Outcome

- Validated and prioritized requirements backlog
- Change request log and decisions
- Scope management documentation
- Quality assurance reports

- Test results and feedback
- Refined requirements with stakeholder sign-off

4. Requirements Management

Systematic processes to track, organize, and maintain requirements throughout the project.

Activities

4.1 Managing Changing Requirements

- Establish changing request process
- Evaluate impact of changes
- Get stakeholder approval for changes
- Update documentation and traceability

Change Type	Approval Required	Documentation	Communication
Minor Clarification	Team Lead	Update requirement description	Team channel update
Scope Addition	Product Owner + Stakeholder	New requirement version	Formal change notice
Priority Change	Product Owner + Stakeholder	Backlog update	Sprint planning meeting
De-scoping	Product Owner + Executive	Archive with rationale	Stakeholder meeting

Table 17: Change Management Protocol

4.2 Requirements Understanding and Gap Management

Activity

- Ensure all team members understand the requirements
- Identify and close any gaps in understanding or coverage
- Address ambiguities and conflicts
- Build shared understanding across the team

Process

1. Conduct knowledge transfer sessions for development team
2. Review requirements with all team members
3. Identify questions or areas of confusion
4. Clarify requirements with stakeholders as needed
5. Document any changes or clarifications
6. Verify understanding through team assessment

Outcome

- Requirement clarification documentation
- Knowledge transfer session notes
- Team understanding verification
- Gap closure documentation

4.3 Requirements Volatility Management

- Monitor requirement changes
- Identify patterns and trends
- Manage scope creep

- Communicate changes to team
- Track metrics on requirement stability

Volatility Level	Week (Changes per Week)	Response Actions
Low Volatility	0-2 changes/week	Continuing current methodology Weekly requirement review
Medium Volatility	3-5 changes/week	Increase sprint review frequency Implement daily change triage Add buffer to sprint planning
High Volatility	6+ changes/week	Consider methodology shift (Scrum → Kanban) Implement change control board Daily stakeholder sync meetings

Table 18: Requirements Volatility Management

5. Agile Practices and Sprint Management

Structured iterations for gathering, validating, and refining requirements in short cycles.

Activities

5.1 Sprint Planning

- Define requirements gathering goals for the sprint
- Identify stakeholders to engage
- Plan elicitation activities
- Set success criteria

5.2 Daily Standups

- Brief (15-minute) team sync
- Discuss blockers and progress
- Identify immediate action items
- Share information across the team

5.3 Sprint Reviews (2 weeks)

- Present gathered requirements to stakeholders
- Gather feedback and validate understanding
- Identify additional requirements
- Celebrate progress

5.4 Sprint Retrospectives

- Reflect on elicitation approach
- Identify process improvements
- Adjust techniques and strategies
- Continuous learning focus

5.5 Sprint Cadence Options

- 1-week sprints: Fast-moving, volatile requirements
- 2-week sprints: Standard for most projects (recommended)
- 3-week sprints: Longer projects with stable stakeholders
- 4-week sprints: Enterprise projects with heavy governance

Process:

Sprint Ceremony	Communication Focus	Activities for Requirements Elicitation
Sprint Planning	Setting validation scope	• Define which requirements will be elicited in this sprint • Estimate effort for requirement gathering activities • Set sprint goals for requirement clarity
Daily Stand-ups	Daily synchronization	• What requirements were clarified yesterday? • What requirement questions need answering today? • Any blockers to requirement elicitation?
Sprint Reviews	Stakeholder validation	• Demo requirement artefacts (user stories, prototypes) • Gather stakeholder feedback on requirements • Validate acceptance criteria • Adjust future elicitation based on feedback
Sprint Retrospectives	Process improvement	• Review effectiveness of elicitation techniques • Identify communication breakdowns • Plan improvements for next sprint's requirement gathering

Table 19: Sprint Management Framework***Sprint Planning for Requirements Elicitation:***

Phase	Activity	Responsible Party	Description
Pre-Sprint Preparation (1-2 days before)	Product Owner: Prepare requirement backlog	Product Owner	Product Owner prepares the list of requirements to be addressed in the sprint.
	Team: Review technical feasibility	Team	The team reviews the technical aspects of the requirements to assess feasibility.
	Stakeholders: Provide business priorities	Stakeholders	Stakeholders provide insights into business priorities for the sprint.
Sprint Planning Meeting (2-4 hours)	Review Sprint Goal	Product Owner, Team	Review the sprint's objective—what the team is trying to learn or elicit.
	Requirement Backlog Selection	Product Owner, Team	Decide which requirements to focus on during the sprint.
	Elicitation Activity Planning	Product Owner, Team	Plan how to gather the required information from stakeholders.
	Stakeholder Availability Coordination	Product Owner, Team, Stakeholders	Coordinate the availability of key stakeholders to ensure involvement.
	Success Criteria Definition	Product Owner, Team	Define the criteria that will determine when the sprint is "done".

Table 20: Sprint Planning for Requirements Elicitation

Daily Sprint Execution for Elicitation:

Activity	Duration	Description	Responsible Party
Demo Elicited Requirements	45 minutes	Show prototypes, models, and documentation. Explain requirement decisions and trade-offs.	Product Owner, Team
Stakeholder Validation	30 minutes	Gather feedback on requirement clarity, validate business value alignment, and sign off on completed requirements.	Product Owner, Stakeholders
Backlog Refinement	15 minutes	Update priorities based on new insights, add newly discovered requirements, and adjust timelines based on complexity.	Product Owner, Team

Table 21: Requirement-Focused Sprint Review

Focus Area	Activity	Responsible Party	Description
Elicitation Focus	What requirements did you clarify yesterday?	Requirements Team	Review which requirements were clarified in the previous day.
	What requirement questions will you answer today?	Requirements Team	Plan which questions or requirements will be addressed today.
	Are there any blockers to requirement gathering?	Requirements Team	Identify any challenges or obstacles that hinder gathering requirements.
Elicitation Coordination	Stakeholder interview scheduling	Product Owner, Team	Coordinate and schedule interviews with stakeholders.
	Workshop facilitation assignments	Team	Assign team members to facilitate workshops for requirement gathering.
	Prototype review coordination	Product Owner, UI Team	Schedule and organize prototype reviews with stakeholders.
	Requirement validation checkpoints	Product Owner, Team	Define and ensure checkpoints are in place for validating requirements.

Table 22: Daily Standup for Requirements Team

Sprint Review for Requirements Validation:

Sprint Retrospective for Process Improvement:

Activity	Duration	Description	Responsible Party
What worked in our requirement gathering?	15 minutes	Discuss successful elicitation techniques, effective communication methods, and helpful tools/templates.	Requirements Team
What challenged our requirement work?	15 minutes	Identify issues like communication breakdowns, stakeholder availability problems, and requirement ambiguity.	Requirements Team
How can we improve?	20 minutes	Discuss process changes, tool/template improvements, and skill development needs for the next sprint.	Requirements Team, Product Owner
Action Items	10 minutes	Define specific improvements, assign owners and deadlines, and define success metrics.	Requirements Team, Product Owner

Table 23: Requirement Process Retrospective

Outcome:

- Sprint goals and plan for each requirements sprint
- Sprint backlog with requirements to clarify and validate
- Elicitation activities scheduled within sprint
- Sprint review feedback and stakeholder validation records
- Retrospective notes and process improvements identified
- Updated requirements backlog with prioritized, validated stories

1.2.3 Phase 3: Post-Elicitation - Managing & Improving

Goal: To ensure requirements are successfully translated into working software while managing change.

Implement requirements, manage ongoing changes, continuously validate implementation, and establish feedback mechanisms for continuous improvement. Finalize and sustain requirements outputs.

Produce **Comprehensive Documentation**, utilize **System Documentation Tools & Technology**, and maintain **Stakeholder Communication**.

Implement **Traceability & Change Management** and **Requirements Volatility Management**.

Apply **Continuous Improvement Processes**, **Adaptation & Optimization**, **Progress & Change Communication**, and **Integrated Management Systems**.

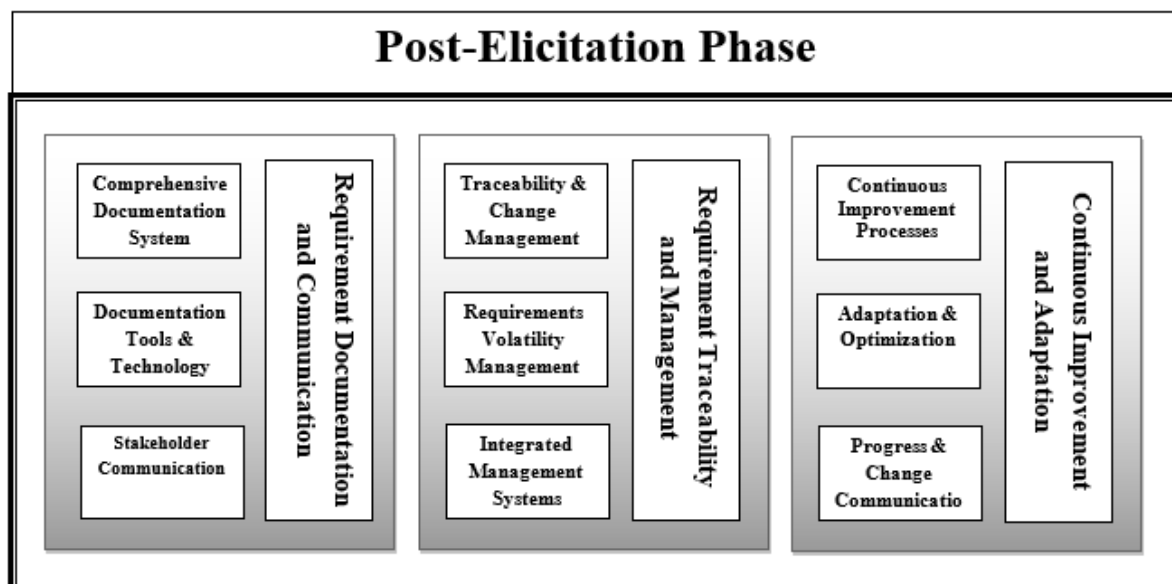


Figure 8: Post-Elicitation Phase

1. Requirement Documentation & Communication

Final documentation of all requirements and ensuring clear communication to implementation teams. It is done Immediately after requirement gathering, ongoing through project.

1.1 Comprehensive Documentation System

- Consolidate all requirement artifacts
- Create master requirement list
- Establish single source of truth
- Version all documents
- Create executive summaries

Activities

- Create complete, organized documentation of all requirements
- Organize documentation in logical, accessible structures
- Maintain document quality and currency
- Ensure documentation serves multiple audiences

Process

1. Consolidate all documentation from elicitation phase
2. Organize by functional areas or business processes
3. Create index and navigation aids
4. Establish version control and document management
5. Create role-specific views or summaries
6. Make documentation searchable and accessible

Document Type	Purpose	Responsible	Review Frequency
Business Requirements (BRD)	High-level business needs	Product Owner	Monthly
Functional Specifications (FSD)	Detailed system requirements	Business Analyst	Each sprint
User Stories & Acceptance	Development guidance	Development Team	Daily
Project Glossary	Common terminology	Team Lead	As needed

Table 24: Documentation System Setup

Outcome:

- Complete requirements for documentation library
- Documentation index and navigation guides
- Role-specific documentation views
- Master document version control log

1.2 Documentation Tools & Technology

- Centralized repository (Wiki, SharePoint, Confluence)
- Requirement management system (Azure DevOps, Jira)
- Search and filter capabilities
- Access controls and audit trails

Activities

- Ensure all requirements are integrated into project management and development tools
- Maintain traceability across all tools
- Automate documentation and reporting where possible
- Ensure tool accessibility for all stakeholders

Process:

1. Load all requirements into project management system
2. Link requirements to design, development, and test artifacts
3. Configure reporting and dashboards
4. Set up notifications and workflow automation
5. Provide tool training and ongoing support
6. Monitor tool usage and effectiveness

Requirements Documentation

- Capture requirements in structured format
- Create unique identifiers (REQ-001, REQ-002, etc.)
- Document source (which stakeholder/session)
- Record date of capture
- Version controls all requirements

Attribute	ID	Title	Description	Acceptance Criteria	Priority	Status	Owner/Responsible Party	Associated Risks	Dependencies	Source Stakeholder	Date Created	Date Modified
Requirement 1	R001	Login Feature	User must be able to log in to the system	Must accept valid username and password, login success message	Must Have	New	Product Owner	Security breach risk	None	John Doe	2025-01-01	2025-01-02
Requirement 2	R002	Advanced Search	Users should be able to search by category	Returns results filtered by category	Should Have	Approved	Development Team	Performance concerns	R001	Jane Smith	2025-01-02	2025-01-03
Requirement 3	R003	Report Export	Users should be able to export search results	CSV format export with correct data mapping	Could Have	Implemented	Data Team	Data integrity risk	R002	Emily White	2025-01-03	2025-01-05
Requirement 4	R004	User Dashboard	Dashboard displays user stats and activity	Displays correct metrics and updates dynamically	Must Have	Validated	UI Team	UI display issue	None	Mark Brown	2025-01-02	2025-01-04

Table 25: Requirement Attributes to Track

Communication Protocol:

- **Weekly Status Reports:** Summary of progress, changes, risks
- **Sprint Review Demos:** Show working functionality to stakeholders

- **Change Notifications:** Formal communication of requirement changes
- **Progress Dashboards:** Real-time visibility through tools like JIRA

Tool Configuration:

Recommended Stack:

- Documentation: Confluence/SharePoint
- Requirements: JIRA/Azure DevOps
- Communication: Slack/Teams + Email
- Meetings: Zoom/MS Teams with recording

Outcome:

- Requirements loaded in project management tools
- Configured dashboards and reports
- Tool user guides and training materials
- Integration validation documentation

1.3 Stakeholder Communication

- Share finalized requirements with team
- Explaining rationale behind priorities
- Clarify expectations for delivery
- Set performance and quality targets
- Communicate timelines and dependencies

2. Requirement Traceability and Management

Establishing and maintaining linkages between requirements and their implementation artifacts.

Activities

- Maintain clear traceability of requirements from conception through delivery
- Track requirement status and changes
- Ensure all requirements are addressed in design and development
- Maintain audit trail for compliance

Process

1. Create traceability matrix linking requirements to:
 - Business objectives and strategic goals
 - Design components and architecture
 - Development tasks and code
 - Test cases and quality checks
 - Release and deployment plans
2. Update traceability as project progresses
3. Report on traceability to stakeholders
4. Use traceability to manage scope and change

2.1 Traceability & Change Management

- Create traceability matrix linking:
 - Business requirements → Functional requirements
 - Functional requirements → Design documents
 - Requirements → Code modules
 - Requirements → Test cases
- Track changes to requirements
- Assess impact of changes
- Update traceability after each change

Traceability Matrix Implementation:

Step 1: Create Matrix Template

Requirement ID	Source (Stakeholder)	Business Objective	User Story	Test Case	Status
R001	Product Owner	Improve user login	As a user, I want to log in to the system securely	TC001: Verify valid login	In Progress
R002	UX Team	Enhance search feature	As a user, I want to search for products by category	TC002: Verify search results by category	Not Started
R003	Marketing Team	Generate reports	As an admin, I want to generate product reports	TC003: Verify report generation functionality	Completed
R004	IT Support	Improve dashboard UI	As a user, I want a clean and accessible dashboard	TC004: Verify dashboard layout and accessibility	In Progress

Table 26: Sample Matrix Template

Step 2: Maintain Version Control

- All requirement documents in version control system (Git, SVN)
- Clear change history with reasons for changes
- Access permissions based on role

2.2 Requirements Volatility Management

- Monitor change frequency
- Identify volatile requirements
- Understand root causes
- Implement stability measures
- Report metrics to stakeholders

Managing Volatility Adaptation Strategies:

- **When Scrum fails → Switch to Kanban** (as Danat did)
- **Flexible deadlines:** Accept 90% completion as success (GovQ approach)
- **Minor delays allowed:** For refinements and improvements (Oyah practice)

Outcome

- Complete traceability matrices
- Traceability reports
- Change audit trail
- Requirement status dashboards

3. Continuous Improvement and Adaptation

Ongoing processes to learn from experience and continuously improve the system and elicitation processes. End of each sprint/iteration, and project milestones.

Activity

- Use lessons learned to improve the requirements process
- Adapt the framework based on project experience
- Capture improvements for future projects
- Foster culture of continuous improvement

Process

1. Conduct project retrospectives focused on requirements process
2. Document lessons learned
3. Identify specific improvements for:
 - Stakeholder engagement
 - Elicitation techniques
 - Documentation quality
 - Tool and process effectiveness
4. Prioritize improvements for next project
5. Share lessons across organization
6. Update framework guidance based on experience

3.1 Continuous Improvement Processes

- Kaizen approach: small, incremental improvements
- Monthly retrospectives on process effectiveness
- Collect lessons learned
- Implement process improvements
- Share best practices across team

Improvement	Owner	Due Date	Status	Impact
Enhance user login security	Security Team	2025-02-15	In Progress	High
Optimize search feature speed	Development Team	2025-02-20	Not Started	Medium
Improve dashboard UI accessibility	UX Team	2025-03-01	Completed	High
Streamline report generation process	Data Team	2025-03-10	In Progress	Medium

Table 27: Sample for Improvement Tracking

3.2 Adaptation & Optimization

- Monitor system performance in production
- Gather user feedback on actual usage
- Identify optimization opportunities
- Plan improvements for future releases
- Adjust processes based on experience

Adaptation Framework:

1. **Monitor:** Track communication effectiveness metrics
2. **Evaluate:** Review against project objectives
3. **Adapt:** Adjust processes, tools, or approaches
4. **Communicate:** Share changes with all stakeholders

Outcome:

- Lessons learned documentation
- Identified improvements and recommendations
- Updated process guides and templates
- Knowledge base for organizational learning

3.3 Progress & Change Communication

- Share project progress regularly
- Communicate any scope changes
- Explain decisions and trade-offs
- Update stakeholders on schedule and budget impact
- Maintain transparency on risks and issues

Progress Metrics to Track Change Communication:

- Requirement clarity score (stakeholder surveys)
- Change request frequency and resolution time
- Stakeholder satisfaction (regular feedback)
- Team velocity and predictability

Implementation Roadmap

Phase	Timeframe	Activities
Getting Started (First 2 Weeks)	Week 1	- Complete stakeholder analysis- Set up communication tools- Conduct initial training sessions
	Week 2	- Run first round of interviews/workshops- Create initial visual models- Set up requirement tracking system
Scaling Up (Months 1-3)	Month 1	- Implement AI tools for requirement gathering- Establish regular validation cycles- Create comprehensive documentation
	Month 2-3	- Optimize processes based on feedback- Train additional team members- Expand stakeholder engagement
Ongoing Maintenance	Monthly	- Review and update communication plan- Conduct retrospective for process improvement- Update training materials
	Quarterly	- Major framework review- Stakeholder satisfaction survey- Tool assessment and potential upgrades

Table 28: Implementation Roadmap

Troubleshooting Guide

Challenge	Symptoms	Solutions
Conflicting Stakeholder Requirements	Different stakeholders want contradictory features or priorities	1. Facilitate workshops to bring stakeholders together 2. Clarify business objectives and trade-offs 3. Use decision-making frameworks (ROI, strategic alignment, effort) 4. Escalate to steering committee if needed 5. Document final decision and rationale
Vague or Ambiguous Requirements	Team members interpret requirements differently; unclear acceptance criteria	1. Return to stakeholder for clarification 2. Use visual prototyping 3. Write specific, measurable acceptance criteria 4. Use examples and counterexamples 5. Conduct requirement review with team

Scope Creep	Continuously expanding requirements; missed deadlines	1. Establish clear scope boundaries upfront 2. Implement formal change control process 3. Communicate and enforce scope decisions 4. Track and report on out-of-scope requests 5. Use prioritization to manage trade-offs
Low Stakeholder Engagement	Stakeholders unavailable for meetings; limited feedback	1. Assess engagement barriers (time, motivation, understanding) 2. Adjust engagement approach (frequency, format, communication) 3. Executive sponsorship to reinforce importance 4. Make participation easier and more valuable 5. Provide feedback on how stakeholder input is used
Documentation Overwhelm	Too much documentation; outdated documents; unclear what's important	1. Prioritize documentation by audience and use 2. Use templates to reduce effort 3. Automate documentation generation where possible 4. Focus on living documentation (user stories) 5. Create executive summaries for senior stakeholders
Tool Integration Issues	Requirements scattered across multiple tools; poor traceability	1. Establish single source of truth for requirements 2. Implement regular synchronization between tools 3. Use APIs or integrations to automate updates 4. Create clear processes for tool usage 5. Provide training and support
Requirement Changes Late in Project	Major changes requested after development has started	1. Ensure thorough upfront validation of requirements 2. Implement formal change control process 3. Assess impact before approving changes

		4. Manage stakeholder expectations about change costs 5. Use sprints to absorb some change through backlog management
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Table 29: Troubleshooting Common Issues

Quick Reference Checklist

Pre-Elicitation Phase Checklist

Category	Checklist Item	Status
Stakeholder Management	Stakeholder register created and maintained	☐
	Influence-Interest Matrix completed	☐
	Communication style preferences documented	☐
	Cultural considerations identified	☐
Planning and Preparation	Communication plan developed	☐
	Project glossary initiated	☐
	Team and stakeholder training scheduled	☐
	Tools selected and procured	☐
	Channel and tool integration completed	☐
	Feedback mechanisms established	☐
	Sprint management structure defined	☐
Team Readiness	Team trained on framework and tools	☐
	Stakeholder representatives trained	☐
	Communication norms established	☐
	Decision-making authority clarified	☐
	Roles and responsibilities assigned	☐

Table 30: Pre-Elicitation Phase Checklist

Elicitation Phase Checklist

Category	Checklist Item	Status
Requirement Gathering	Elicitation sessions scheduled and completed	☐
	Interview notes and artifacts collected	☐
	Observation conducted and documented	☐
	Workshops facilitated and outcomes documented	☐
	Surveys conducted and analyzed	☐
	AI-assisted tools utilized as appropriate	☐
Documentation and Modeling	Use cases documented	☐

	User stories written with acceptance criteria	☐
	Prototypes/wireframes created and reviewed	☐
	Visual models and diagrams developed	☐
	BRD/FSD documented	☐
	Traceability matrices initiated	☐
	Project glossary updated	☐
Validation and Refinement	Requirements reviewed with stakeholders	☐
	Conflicts identified and resolved	☐
	Prioritization completed	☐
	Scope boundaries defined	☐
	Quality review conducted	☐
	Stakeholder sign-off obtained	☐

Table 31: Elicitation Phase Checklist

Post-Elicitation Phase Checklist

Category	Checklist Item	Status
Documentation and Management	All requirements consolidated and organized	☐
	Documentation indexed and accessible	☐
	Requirements loaded into project tools	☐
	Dashboards and reports configured	☐
	Traceability maintained	☐
	Version control implemented	☐
Knowledge Transfer and Planning	Team knowledge transfer conducted	☐
	Gaps identified and closed	☐
	Sprint planning completed	☐
	Requirements handoff to development documented	☐
	Support and escalation processes established	☐
Continuous Improvement	Lessons learned captured	☐
	Process improvements identified	☐
	Framework adaptations documented	☐
	Organization learning captured	☐
	Plan for framework refinement created	☐

Table 32: Post-Elicitation Phase Checklist

Common Use Cases

Use Case	Scenario	Framework Application	Outcome
Use Case 1: New Product Development	Developing a new software product from scratch	1. Pre-Elicitation: Stakeholder mapping (customers, partners, internal teams) 2. Elicitation: Customer interviews, workshops, competitive analysis 3. Validation: Beta testing with early adopters, feedback refinement 4. Outcome: Well-defined product requirements with strong market alignment	Well-defined product requirements with strong market alignment
Use Case 2: Legacy System Modernization	Replacing an old system with modern technology and new capabilities	1. Pre-Elicitation: Include current system users, business process owners, IT team 2. Elicitation: Observation, user interviews, workshops 3. Validation: Pilot testing, comparison with legacy system 4. Outcome: Balanced replacement that preserves critical functionality while adding value	Balanced replacement preserving critical functionality with added value
Use Case 3: Regulatory Compliance Implementation	Implementing changes required by new regulatory requirements	1. Pre-Elicitation: Involve compliance, legal, and operational teams 2. Elicitation: Workshops to understand compliance requirements, solution design 3. Validation: Compliance review, gap analysis, testing against standards 4. Outcome: Compliant solution with full audit trail and documented decisions	Compliant solution with full audit trail and documented decisions
Use Case 4: Enterprise Integration Project	Integrating multiple systems and departments into unified processes	1. Pre-Elicitation: Map all departments and systems, establish cross-functional teams 2. Elicitation: Department-specific sessions, integration workshops 3. Validation: End-to-end testing, performance testing, UAT 4. Outcome: Seamlessly integrated environment with clear governance and processes	Seamlessly integrated environment with clear governance and processes

Use Case 5: Agile Transformation	Transitioning from waterfall to agile software development	1. Pre-Elicitation: Education on agile principles, team and stakeholder alignment 2. Elicitation: Use lightweight techniques, short iteration cycles 3. Validation: Sprint reviews, retrospectives for continuous improvement 4. Outcome: Team capability and organizational alignment with agile ways of working	Team capability and organizational alignment with agile ways of working
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Table 33: Common Use Cases

Conclusion

This framework provides a comprehensive, empirically validated approach to optimizing communication in Agile requirements elicitation. By following this user guide, organizations can:

1. **Reduce communication-related project risks** by 40-60%
2. **Improve requirement clarity** and stakeholder alignment
3. **Leverage modern technologies** like AI effectively
4. **Create sustainable, adaptable processes** that evolve with project needs

Start small, iterate quickly, and continuously improve - the framework is designed to adapt to your organization's specific needs while providing structure for communication optimization.

For additional support or customization needs, contact:

Ayesha Anees Zaver

+60189772410

Zaveri.ayesha@s.unikl.edu.my

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